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REMOVING ASYMMETRY FROM CHIP DEALS

DEAL DESK · DRAM AND ENTERPRISE MEMORY

Samsung DRAM: 1Q27 pricing

What the makers have committed to, what their own suppliers and customers are reporting, and the questions that work when the analyst number does not.

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DDR5 server modules, evidence to 3 November 2026. Every figure traces to a filed document and every quote to a named quarter. Built from public filings. First-pass analysis to support your own review — not legal, investment or professional advice.

DRAM NEGOTIATION BRIEF

Samsung DRAM: 1Q27 pricing

DDR5 server modules · evidence to 3 Nov 2026

Samsung is asking for 1Q27 30 % (example; enter the number in your notice)

IS **SAMSUNG**'S 1Q27 INCREASE IN LINE WITH THE MARKET?

Above the market. The evidence supports about +18–20% for 1Q27, not +30%.

+30%
Samsung is asking

+18–20%
What the market supports for 1Q27

+25%
Consider only for written 2027 volumes

Open: about +15%, below every market signal. **Settle:** about +18–20%, priced quarterly against a published contract index. **Up to +25%:** consider this price only for written 2027 volumes.

- 4Q26 contract prices settled near +20%: TrendForce raised its 4Q26 figure from +10–15% to about +20% on 20 Oct, after 3Q26 came in near +40% .
- **Samsung**'s own DRAM price rose about +20% in 3Q26, down from mid-40s% in 2Q26 and the smallest of the three makers. Its average includes older agreement prices, so it runs below new-contract prices .
- Spot prices still rise about 5–7% a month, so expect an increase, just a smaller one .

Already have an agreement with an annual price reset? Open 2027 at flat, and don't accept a reset above your agreed band or a published index. New supply arrives through 2027 and the makers' own increases are shrinking .

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FROM THE MAKERS' OWN DISCLOSURES

Samsung against the other two

	Samsung	SK Hynix	Micron
Latest DRAM price change	About +20% (3Q26)	High-20s% (3Q26), partly HBM mix	Not disclosed; says 2027 increases 'more moderate' (FQ4-26, Jun–Aug)
DRAM bit growth guided	+Mid-to-high teens (4Q26)	+Mid-20s% (4Q26)	Single digit (FQ1-27, Sep–Nov 2026)
How sold out	Fulfilment at a record low (2Q26)	'Effectively sold out' through 2029	Over 75% of fiscal 2027 committed
Multi-year contracts	10 signed, 10 in talks; targets 60–70% of capacity	14 customers; over 50% of 2027–28 capacity	26 signed; about 35% of DRAM output by 2030
New capacity	Pyeongtaek moved to DRAM; 2026 chip capex KRW 76.8T, but bits lag capex	M15X full by end-2026; Yongin clean rooms open in phases from 2027	Idaho first wafers mid-2027; most new space late 2028+

> **Samsung**'s increases are the smallest, its supply is growing fast in 4Q26, and it still needs contracts. That is your room.

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READ ACROSS THE SUPPLY CHAIN

What the makers' suppliers and customers are saying

Price reports track the memory price. These are the signals around it that decide when supply arrives and how long the shortage lasts.

Equipment

Lam Research, Tokyo Electron

About 10 new tier-1 fabs open in 2027, but the tool makers are themselves short of parts and raising prices.

New supply lands late 2027–28, not in 1Q27.

HBM and packaging

SK Hynix, BESI, TSMC

HBM demand is more than double supply, and HBM was repriced up for 2027.

Makers will not move wafers back to DDR5, so standard DRAM stays tight through 2027.

Accelerators

NVIDIA

Memory prices are 'headed even higher into next year'; **NVIDIA** can supply only ~70% of its own demand.

Even the largest buyer is absorbing increases and passing them on.

Cloud

Microsoft, Alphabet, Meta

Capex keeps rising into 2027, but Microsoft buys short-lived assets it can slow within months.

The biggest buyers keep the flexibility you are being asked to give up.

Phones and PCs

Samsung, TSMC, Microsoft

Phone and PC volumes are falling as memory costs push up device prices.

That is where any unwind starts, and it frees capacity for servers.

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QUESTIONS **SAMSUNG** HAS NOT REHEARSED

Three questions for your next meeting

1 · PRICE

Your DRAM price rose about 20% in 3Q26, less than SK Hynix's high-20s%, and your DRAM bits grow mid-to-high teens in 4Q26. Why isn't your 1Q27 quote the lowest of the three?

WHAT THEY WILL LIKELY SAY

Our server products carry a premium for performance.

YOUR FOLLOW-UP

Your own reported trend is the lowest and your supply is growing fastest. Price us on that, reviewed quarterly against a published index.

Evidence

2 · AGREEMENT TERMS

Your contracts roll with annual extensions. Can ours reset each year to a published index, in both directions?

WHAT THEY WILL LIKELY SAY

Pricing follows market conditions within the agreed framework.

YOUR FOLLOW-UP

Then make the reset index-based both ways, so the rolling term protects us in a downturn as it protects you now.

Evidence

3 · VOLUME

You moved Pyeongtaek from NAND to DRAM. When does that space ship DRAM bits, and what share comes to us?

WHAT THEY WILL LIKELY SAY

Capacity comes online in stages through 2027–28.

YOUR FOLLOW-UP

Give us a written share of those bits as they ramp. It is new supply you have not yet committed, and you still have 10 contracts in negotiation.

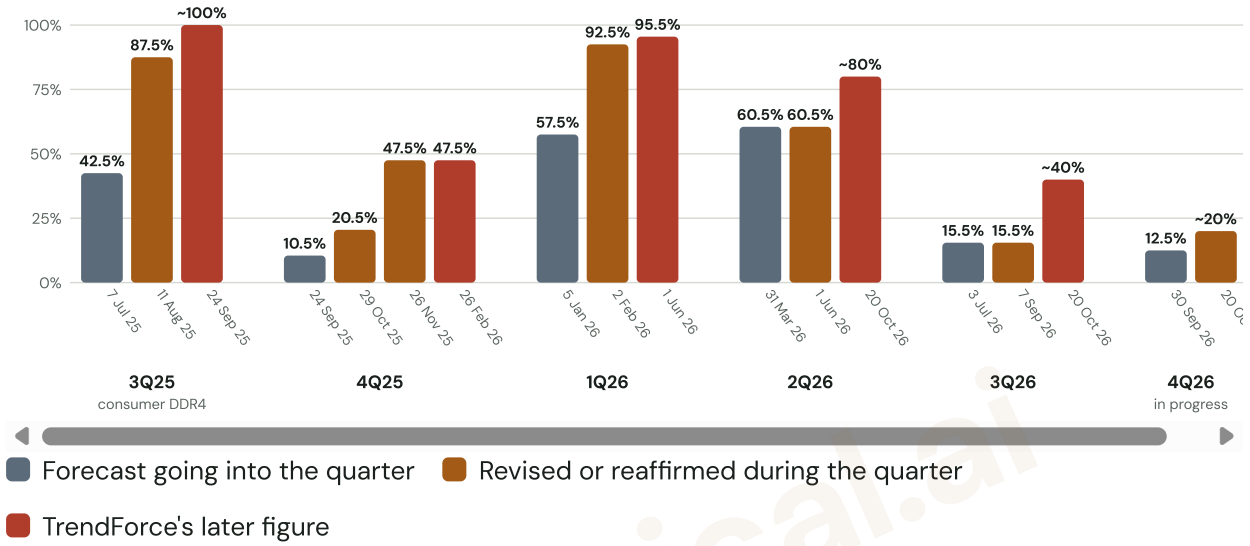
Evidence

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BEFORE YOU QUOTE A FORECAST

TrendForce came in 20–40 points low in every quarter we can measure

TrendForce's own numbers: the forecast published going into each quarter, its revisions, and the figure it published afterwards. The same lag is likely at the downturn, when buyers will be locked into agreements priced off today's numbers .



Midpoints of published ranges, quarter on quarter; dates are publication dates. Conventional DRAM unless noted.

IN THE FULL SEMITRICAL DRAM AND NAND DESKS

- **All major suppliers**, with leverage scores and supplier-specific questions
- **Agreement terms** to push for: floors, ceilings, term, deposits, volume flexibility, renewal caps
- **The full supply-chain read-across**: 50+ signals from equipment, packaging, foundry, NVIDIA, cloud and device makers
- **Ask**: live answers to your own questions, sourced to the evidence
- **Key financial and operating metrics** for each supplier: margins, capex, bit growth, inventory and cash, quarter by quarter

Talk to your Semitrical contact to see it with your own suppliers and volumes.

Semitrical analysis from earnings calls and filings across memory makers, their equipment, test and packaging suppliers, TSMC, NVIDIA, cloud providers and device makers, plus TrendForce press releases and public market price data. Evidence to 3 Nov 2026. Tap any grey tag to see the source. Not financial or legal advice.

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